

Mobile and Phone Number Protection

Protect the phone number that many accounts use for recovery and alerts.

Audience	Phone users, caregivers, older adults, and families with shared plans.
Purpose	Reduce SIM swap, account recovery abuse, and mobile account risk.
Best use	Use when setting up a new phone or reviewing a family phone plan.

Warning signs

[]	Phone suddenly shows no service or SOS only.
[]	Carrier sends an alert about a SIM change you did not request.
[]	Accounts send password reset or new device notices.
[]	Someone asks you to read a code from a text message.

Protection steps

[]	Add a carrier PIN or passcode.
[]	Ask the carrier about number transfer lock.
[]	Use an authenticator app when possible instead of text codes.
[]	Update the phone and apps.
[]	Review app permissions and remove unused apps.

Keep this guide near the device or account it protects. Small habits make a real difference when they are repeated.